

Product Management with Generative & Agentic AI
BITSOM x Masai

Phase 1 Submission

**Digitally Visible, Financially Invisible: A Product Strategy for
Financial Inclusion in the Urban Service Workforce**

Group Members:

Yash Lele - BITSOM_PM_25111698

Nishtha Garg - BITSOM_PM_25111591

Submitted On: 30/01/2026

Team Contribution

The Phase 1 submission was completed through collaborative effort, with responsibilities distributed across conceptual analysis, research, and documentation.

Yash Lele - BITSoM_PM_25111698

- Contributed to defining the **problem statement and contextual background**
 - Worked on **idea exploration frameworks** including Brainstorming, ERRC, and SCAMPER
 - Contributed to **customer identification**, segmentation, and phased market focus
 - Worked on **competitive landscape analysis**
 - Contributed to the **Core Value Proposition (CVP)** and **Value Proposition Canvas**
 - Worked on business model components including:
 - Customer switching rationale
 - Unit of sale
 - Revenue models
 - Worked on the **Phase 1 experimental task**, including: (Swiggy)
 - Collection of raw problem signals
 - Documentation of verbatim user complaints
 - Refinement of the selected pain point
 - Assisted in structuring and reviewing the Phase 1 document for guideline alignment
-

Nishtha Garg - BITSoM_PM_25111591

- Contributed to understanding the **problem context** through secondary research
- Participated in **idea exploration and validation discussions**
- Assisted with documenting **customer-related observations**
- Worked on business model components including:
 - Demand forecasting approach
 - Cost structure
 - Key metrics
- Worked on the **Phase 1 experimental task**, including: (WhatsApp & Instagram)
 - Collection of raw problem signals
 - Documentation of verbatim user complaints
- Reviewed the document for clarity and completeness prior to submission

Table of Contents

1. Problem Chosen & Context	4
Problem Overview	4
2. Idea Exploration.....	4
2.1 Brainstorming	4
2.2 ERRC Framework.....	4
2.3 SCAMPER Framework	5
3. Sources of Ideas & Validation Approach	6
Sources.....	6
Approach.....	6
4. Customers	6
4.1 Primary Customers.....	6
4.2 Customer Segmentation & Phased Focus	6
4.3 Stages of Market Expansion Strategy	7
5. Competition.....	7
6. Core Value Proposition (CVP)	7
7. Value Proposition Canvas.....	8
7.1 Customer Jobs.....	8
7.2 Customer Pains	8
7.3 Customer Gains.....	8
7.4 Products & Services.....	8
7.5 Pain Relievers	8
7.6 Gain Creators	8
8. Why will customers switch to your solution?	9
9. What is the unit of sale?	9
10. What are the revenue models?	9
11. How will you forecast demand?	9
12. What will be some key elements of the cost structure?	9
13. What are the key metrics?	10
Experimental Task	10
Objective	10
1. Problem Signals – Swiggy:.....	10
2. Problem Signals – WhatsApp:	12
3. Problem Signals – Instagram:	14
4. Refined Pain Point – WhatsApp	15

1. Problem Chosen & Context

Problem Overview

In emerging digital economies, a large section of the urban workforce operates through gig platforms such as food delivery, ride-hailing, logistics, and home services. While these workers are digitally active and generate consistent transactional data, they remain excluded from formal financial systems.

Gig workers typically:

- Face unstable daily or weekly income
- Lack access to affordable credit
- Have no financial safety nets for emergencies
- Are unable to build a recognized credit history
- Rely on informal lenders with high interest rates

This results in persistent financial stress and vulnerability, where even minor disruptions, such as illness, vehicle breakdown, or platform suspension can push workers into debt cycles.

In simple terms, they are **digitally visible but financially invisible**.

2. Idea Exploration

2.1 Brainstorming

Initial solution directions explored included:

- Earned wage access for gig workers
- Micro cash advances aligned with daily earnings
- Automated savings linked to completed work
- Emergency protection for downtime
- Alternative credit scoring using platform data
- Financial guidance delivered digitally

2.2 ERRC Framework

The ERRC framework was used to reimagine financial services specifically for urban gig workers by removing assumptions rooted in salaried employment and redesigning financial access around real earning behaviour.

This framework ensures the product is designed around **how gig workers actually earn and spend**, rather than forcing them into rigid banking structures.

ERRC Dimension	Strategic Choice	Rationale
Eliminate	Long approval cycles and paperwork-heavy loan processes	Gig workers require immediate liquidity; delays reduce earning ability and increase informal borrowing
Reduce	Dependence on formal employment proofs and fixed monthly income assumptions	Gig income is irregular but continuous and digitally traceable
Raise	Transparency, trust, and predictability in pricing and repayment	Trust deficits are high due to hidden charges and unclear repayment terms
Create	A behavioural financial identity using gig-platform data	Enables responsible access to credit and savings without traditional credit history

2.3 SCAMPER Framework

The SCAMPER framework was applied to challenge traditional financial product assumptions and adapt them to the realities of gig-based work.

- **Substitute**
Traditional credit scores → **Behavioural scoring based on gig data** (earnings consistency, hours worked, reliability, ratings)
- **Combine**
Liquidity, savings, and financial guidance → **A single, cohesive experience** rather than fragmented financial products
- **Adapt**
Banking products designed for salaried users → **Financial tools aligned to daily or weekly earning cycles**
- **Modify**
Fixed EMI-based repayment → **Earnings-linked, flexible recovery mechanisms**
- **Put to another use**
Platform operational data → **Alternative signals for creditworthiness and financial coaching**
- **Eliminate**
Manual underwriting bias and complex eligibility rules → **Automated, rules-based decisioning with clear guardrails**
- **Reverse**
Credit-first financial journeys → **Liquidity first, followed by savings and long-term financial identity building**

The SCAMPER framework helped refine the solution by rethinking existing financial models. Traditional credit scores are substituted with gig behaviour-based scoring, liquidity and savings are combined into a single experience, and lending cycles are modified to match daily or weekly earning patterns. Manual underwriting and rigid banking constraints are eliminated, enabling a more inclusive and flexible financial product tailored to gig workers.

3. Sources of Ideas & Validation Approach

This product concept was shaped through a combination of qualitative observation, secondary research, and structured product discovery frameworks. The validation approach in Phase 1 focuses on **problem validation and opportunity framing**, rather than solution confirmation.

Sources

- Observations of gig platform workflows
- Secondary research on gig economy growth
- User behaviour patterns from platform economics
- Early informal conversations with gig workers
- Industry reports on financial inclusion

Approach

- Problem framing through behavioural patterns
- Analysis of earning volatility and expense timing
- Identification of gaps in existing financial offerings
- Mapping user pain points to product opportunities

4. Customers

4.1 Primary Customers

The primary customers for this product are urban gig workers such as urban gig workers (delivery partners, ride-hailing drivers, logistics workers) earning ₹15,000–₹60,000 per month with irregular income patterns and lack formal financial recognition.

4.2 Customer Segmentation & Phased Focus

While financial exclusion affects multiple underserved groups, this project intentionally focuses on **urban gig workers** as the primary customer segment in the initial phase.

During early exploration, the following financially underserved segments were also considered:

- Migrant workers with unstable documentation
- Women managing household or micro-business finances
- Senior citizens with low digital literacy
- Semi-urban and rural informal workers

However, these segments differ significantly in income patterns, trust models, onboarding requirements, and regulatory considerations.

For Stage 1, urban gig workers were selected due to:

- High frequency and immediacy of financial need
- Availability of reliable, real-time behavioural and earnings data
- Higher digital readiness and faster adoption potential
- Lower operational and regulatory complexity
- Clear path to early product validation and sustainable ROI

This focused approach enables faster learning, responsible product design, and clearer measurement of impact before scaling.

4.3 Stages of Market Expansion Strategy

This product is designed in stages as an **expansion mindset**, where additional underserved segments are onboarded only after the product demonstrates stability, trust, and positive unit economics in the initial market.

The same AI-led financial infrastructure built for gig workers can be extended to other underserved groups in later stages of the development cycle.

Stage	Target Segment	Rationale
Stage 1	Urban gig workers	High data availability, fast validation
Stage 2	Migrant & informal urban workers	Similar cashflow challenges
Stage 3	Women micro-entrepreneurs	Savings-led growth, lower default risk
Stage 4	Semi-urban & rural users	Partner-led, infrastructure-supported expansion

By sequencing expansion in this manner, the product avoids premature complexity while ensuring long-term scalability across the broader financially underserved population.

5. Competition

The product operates in a fragmented competitive landscape rather than competing with a single direct alternative. Informal lenders such as local money-lenders and peer borrowing are the most commonly used options for gig workers, offering quick access to cash but at extremely high financial and social costs. Digital micro-credit and BNPL platforms provide short-term loans but are often expensive, inflexible, and not tailored to irregular gig income patterns. Traditional banks and NBFCs largely exclude gig workers due to documentation and income stability requirements. Additionally, some gig platforms offer limited wallet advances, but these are closed-loop, inconsistent, and do not help workers build long-term financial identity. None of these alternatives address liquidity, savings, and financial recognition together in a holistic manner.

6.Core Value Proposition (CVP)

The core value proposition of this product is to provide gig workers with instant access to affordable liquidity, automated savings, and a recognized financial identity by leveraging their gig platform data. By aligning financial services with irregular earning patterns, the product reduces reliance on informal borrowing, improves financial resilience, and enables long-term economic stability for an otherwise underserved workforce.

7. Value Proposition Canvas

7.1 Customer Jobs

- Manage daily and weekly cashflow needs
- Continue working without disruptions due to lack of funds
- Handle unexpected expenses or emergencies
- Build financial stability over time
- Gain access to formal credit and financial recognition

7.2 Customer Pains

- Irregular income leading to frequent cashflow gaps
- High-cost informal borrowing during emergencies
- No access to affordable, short-term credit
- Lack of safety nets for downtime or accidents
- Inability to build a recognized credit history

7.3 Customer Gains

- Immediate access to funds when needed
- Reduced financial stress during low-income days
- Automated savings during high-earning periods
- Improved financial confidence and dignity
- Pathway to better credit options in the future

7.4 Products & Services

- Earned wage access and micro cash advances
- Auto-savings linked to completed work
- Alternative credit score based on gig behaviour
- Transparent, mobile-first financial experience

7.5 Pain Relievers

- Fast, documentation-light access to liquidity
- Low-ticket advances aligned to earning cycles
- Automated recovery to avoid debt accumulation
- Clear pricing with no hidden charges

7.6 Gain Creators

- Savings built automatically without manual effort
- Recognition of gig income through alternative data
- Progressive unlock of better financial products
- Long-term financial stability and growth

8. Why will customers switch to your solution?

Gig workers will switch to this solution because existing financial options either exclude them or fail to match their income realities. Traditional banks require stable salaries and documentation, while informal lenders offer quick cash at exploitative costs. This product provides instant access to funds aligned with daily earnings, transparent pricing, and minimal friction, while also helping users save and build a recognized financial identity. The combination of speed, affordability, trust, and relevance to gig work creates a compelling reason to switch.

9. What is the unit of sale?

The primary unit of sale is a small, short-duration cash advance linked to a gig worker's completed work and expected earnings. Each advance is designed to meet immediate needs such as fuel or daily expenses. Secondary units of engagement include automated savings contributions triggered by work completion, and optional protection or insurance add-ons introduced in later phases as user trust and usage mature.

10. What are the revenue models?

Revenue is generated primarily through a small, transparent fee charged per cash advance. Additional revenue streams include commissions from gig platforms for improved worker retention and productivity, interest income from larger credit products unlocked in later phases, and optional micro-insurance or protection add-ons. This diversified model ensures sustainability while keeping costs affordable for users.

11. How will you forecast demand?

Demand forecasting is based on the high frequency and recurring nature of cashflow gaps faced by gig workers. Since daily expenses are unavoidable and income timing is unpredictable, the need for instant liquidity is continuous rather than occasional. Adoption is expected to grow through repeat usage, habit formation via automated features, and distribution through gig platform partnerships and peer referrals within worker communities.

12. What will be some key elements of the cost structure?

The key elements of the cost structure include loan capital sourced through NBFC partnerships, credit risk and default provisions, and technology and data infrastructure costs. Additional costs arise from customer support operations, compliance and KYC requirements, and platform integration efforts. As the product scales, automation and data-driven underwriting are expected to reduce per-user operational costs.

13. What are the key metrics?

Key metrics focus on adoption, engagement, and financial sustainability. These include monthly active users, frequency of cash advance usage, repayment rate, auto-savings opt-in rate, and short- and mid-term retention metrics such as 30-day and 90-day retention. These indicators help assess product-market fit, user trust, and long-term viability.

Experimental Task

Objective

To identify **user complaints** from real app users across three consumer mobile applications, without interpretation or solutioning, and refine a core pain point for one selected app. Applications used for this task are Swiggy, WhatsApp and Instagram.

1. Problem Signals – Swiggy:

[Source link](#)

A. Source: Google Play Store Review

Complaint:

“The support executive are unable to provide any resolution when ever I connect them.”



★☆☆☆☆ 6 January 2026

the support executive are unable to provide any resolution when ever I connect them

Did you find this helpful?

Yes

No

Swiggy

6 January 2026

Hi, we are sorry about this. Please help us with the order id over an email at swiggysocial@swiggy.in, so we can help resolve the issue.

B. Source: Google Play Store Review
Complaint:

“Pathetic and frustrating! Poor delivery and ETA that changes every minute.”



★☆☆☆☆ 6 January 2026

Pathetic and frustrating ! Poor delivery and ETA that changes in every minute

Did you find this helpful?

Yes

No

Swiggy

6 January 2026

Hey there, sorry for the delay in delivering the food. Please share the order details to swiggysocial@swiggy.in and we will check this and address it.

C. Source: Google Play Store Review
Complaint:

“Always takes time to find a delivery partner and a 30 min delivery takes 1 hr.”



★★☆☆☆ 5 January 2026

always takes time to find a delivery partner and a 30 min delivery takes 1hr

Did you find this helpful?

Yes

No

Swiggy

5 January 2026

Hey, we request you to let us know more about your experience by writing us an email at swiggysocial@swiggy.in from your registered email ID so that we can have your concern addressed.

D. Source: Google Play Store Review

Complaint:

“Please stop offloading all queries to your AI bot, it’s really frustrating when it is not able to resolve query neither connecting me with an agent.”



★ ★ ★ ★ ★ 4 January 2026

Please stop offloading all queries to your AI bot. its really frustrating when it is not able to resolve query neither connecting me with an agent.

Did you find this helpful?

Yes

No

Swiggy

4 January 2026

Hey, we request you to let us know more about your experience by writing us an email at swiggysocial@swiggy.in from your registered email ID so that we can have your concern addressed.

2. Problem Signals – WhatsApp:

[Source Link.](#)

A. Source: Google Play Store Review

Complaint:

“WhatsApp freezes on the loading screen when I try to switch accounts, it’s been like that for days not working.”



★ ★ ★ ★ ★ 6 January 2026

WhatsApp freezes on the loading screen when I try to switch accounts it’s been like that for days not working

Did you find this helpful?

Yes

No

B. Source: Google Play Store Review

Complaint:

“I am 50 year I rarely use WhatsApp for family groups and now my account is suspended for no reason, and I can’t even reach real customer service just automated bots.”



★☆☆☆☆ 6 January 2026

I am 50 year I rarely use what's app for family groups and now my account is suspended for no reason, and I can't even reach real customer service just automated bots

Did you find this helpful?

Yes

No

C. Source: Google Play Store Review

Complaint:

“So many problems: -1.) muted conversations DON'T get muted! -2.) I unpin a chat, but it still remains pinned!! So even with only 2 pinned chats, the app won't let me pin a 3rd one! -3.) Also, WhatsApp should NOT force users to download the latest version if they don't want!! Also, I mute a conversation for 8 hours, so many times, but after 5 minutes I get disturbed by notification from the very chat, which I muted!! Fix that!”



★☆☆☆☆ 6 January 2026

So many problems: -1.) muted conversations DON'T get muted! -2.) I unpin a chat, but it still remains pinned!! So even with only 2 pinned chats, the app won't let me pin a 3rd one! -3.) Also, WhatsApp should NOT force users to download the latest version if they don't want to!! Also, I mute a conversation for 8 hours, so many times , but after 5 minutes I get disturbed by notification from the very chat, which I muted!! Fix that!

94 people found this review helpful

Did you find this helpful?

Yes

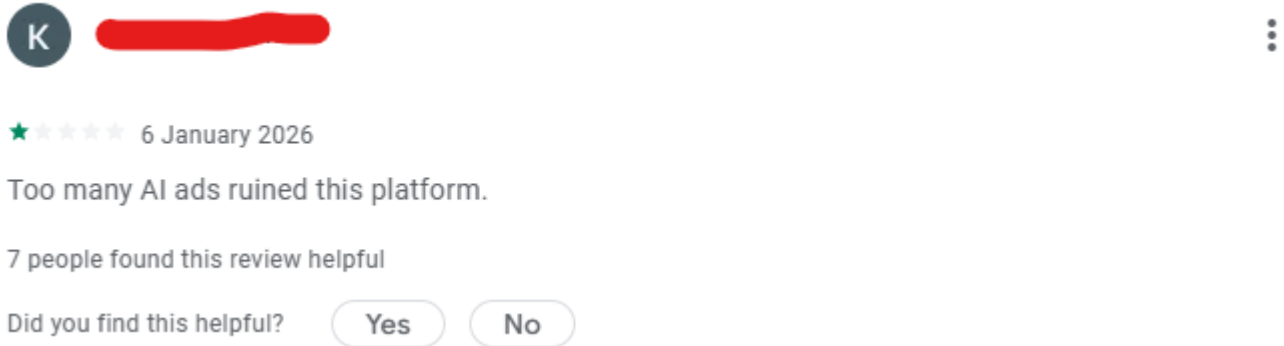
No

3. Problem Signals – Instagram:

[Source Link](#)

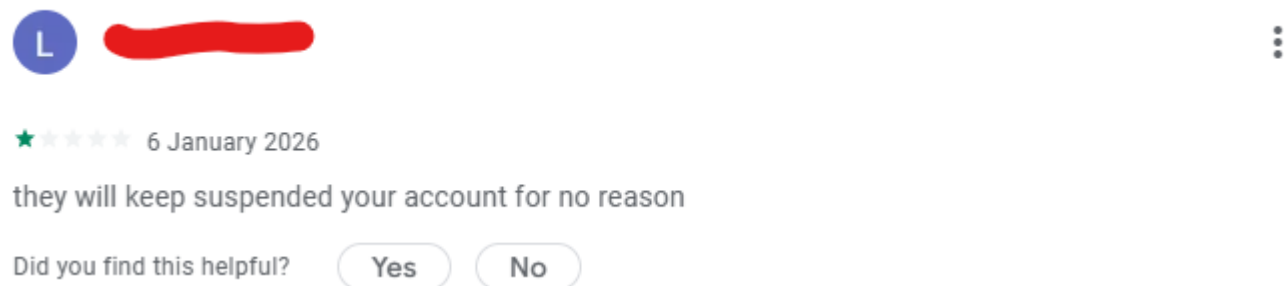
A. Source: Google Play Store Review Complaint:

“Too many AI ads ruined this platform.”



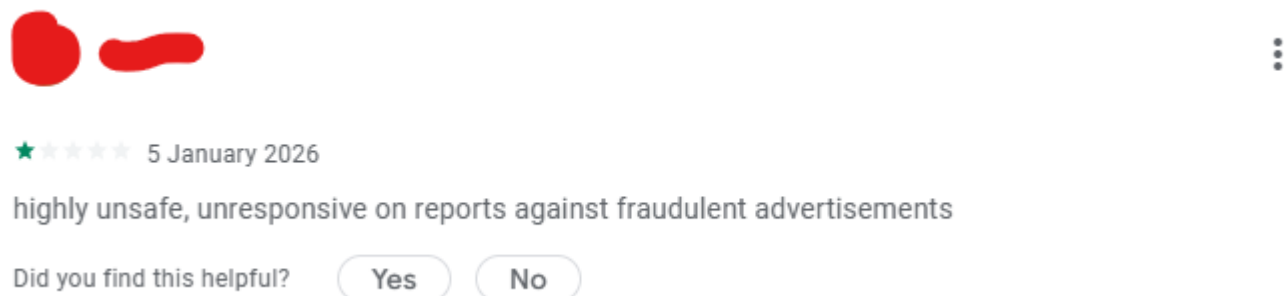
B. Source: Google Play Store Review Complaint:

“They will keep suspended your account for no reason.”



C. Source: Google Play Store Review Complaint:

“Highly unsafe, unresponsive on reports against fraudulent advertisements.”



4. Refined Pain Point – WhatsApp

Refined Pain Point:

Users experience frustration and anxiety due to unexplained account suspensions, unreliable app behaviour, and the absence of accessible human customer support, leading to loss of trust in WhatsApp during critical communication moments.